had strong evidentiary value as compared to what was claimed by an accused in custody. Many experts were of the opinion that Charles's statement should have been taken more seriously. Charles was the only witness to Sivarasan and the other assailants fleeing after killing the EPRLF leader K. Padmanabha in Madras in June 1990. They had stopped Charles in the middle of the road and forcefully taken his Maruti van as a getaway vehicle. The sloppy investigation into the assassination of Padmanabha at that time was seen as collusion between the investigators and the assassins. And the same mastermind of Padmanabha's killing had returned to India and killed again, this time a world leader and India's former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi. Yet, the SIT did not consider it important to investigate the LTTE's nexus with politicians in India.

Even the arrest of R. Nagarajan, who was the home secretary at the time of Padmanabha's assassination in Madras, did not shake the SIT. The investigators tracking the Tamil Tigers' trail believed they had unearthed a massive conspiracy linking militants with politicians who had facilitated the escape of the killers of Padmanabha.[6] According to sources in the CID,

> After two slips, the police had one entire day, during which the militants freely moved in and around Trichy. But the police chose to ignore, or maybe did not know of, the militants' activities. The Tigers not only switched cars but also parked at Santhan's house in Trichy for a night.
>
> On June 14, while the militants waited for three hours on the Ramnathapuram coast for a boat to take them to Jaffna, the locals even provided them rice and fish. The police arrived on the scene but only an hour after they had left and made a token arrest of two local fishermen who had cooked for the LTTE men. When the then DGP appeared on television that night to announce the arrests, he chose not to mention the identity of the two prisoners. The case was reopened only after the Sivarasan nexus was discovered.[7]